Paisley RFC
SEASON 2026/27
PLAYBOOK

Attack Zones Basic Overview (Game Plan)

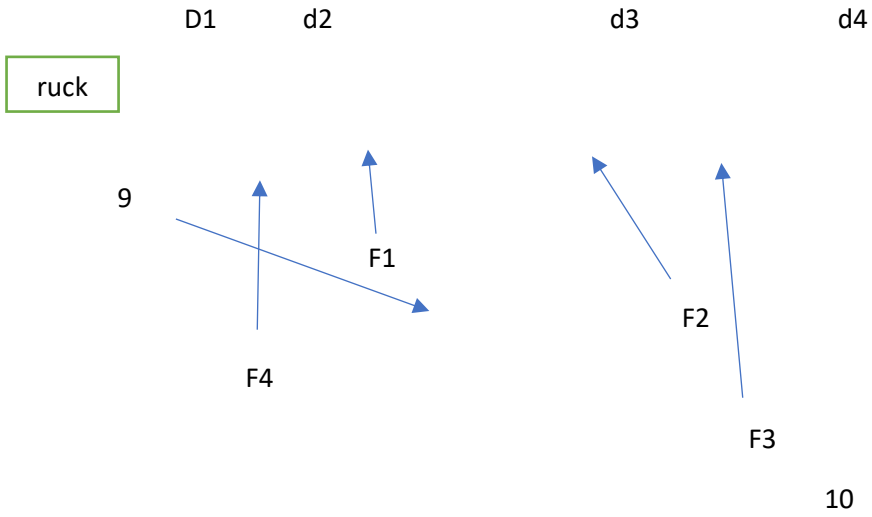
Phase	RED Start: 0-22m	AMBER Start: 22m-0ppo 10m	GREEN Start: Opp. Half
1	Long Kick (10 or 15) Fwd play Chaos move to get angle on kick. Kick must be into touch.	From lineout/scrum Pod 1 attack midfield with (12/13).	Pod 1 attack midfield
2		4 Fwds round the corner **(10 decides if pass off 9 or 10)**	4 Fwds round the corner **(10 decides if pass off 9 or 10)**
3		Ball to (10) and look for space or gaps. Mis-matches Backs vs Fwds. This can be with kick or hands but **kick must go to space and touch grass**	Attack wide to 15m channel - option 1, keep the ball alive (Arrowheads); option 2, if contact made, quick ruck to get ball back in play.
4		Play each phase as it comes Fwds then Backs (heads up rugby)	Next 4 Fwds hit up (lions)
5			Heads up rugby (10) makes the decision to keep going same way or back the way the ball came. We retain the ball till over line.
Arrowheads	When ball carrier makes a break, supporting players angle in (in an arrowhead formation). Giving player options on both sides, either taking pass or providing support in tackle/ruck.		

PLAN B: back to phase two and rebuild the phases.

PLAN C: Kick to the corners, with ball going out of play. Then try and put pressure on opposition to retrieve the ball back. Always look to put pressure on all opposition restarts stops them from developing phases, reduce their option of plays.

AIM: All of this is to get into opposition's half and take as many points as we can first (build a lead). To keep the score board ticking over. Once we have a lead then we can go for bonus try points.

Forwards open play calls

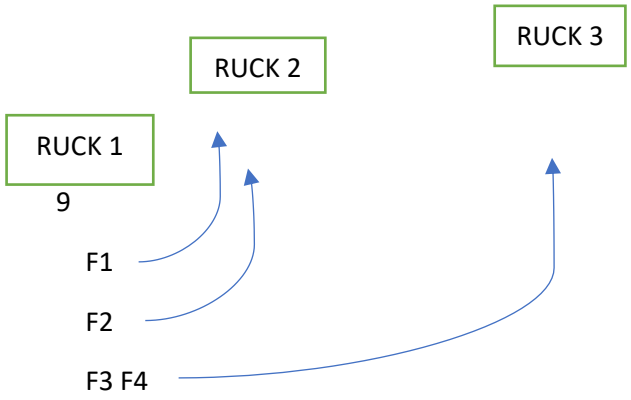


- **PUNCH:** 9 PASSES TO F1 MOVES FORWARD AND PASSES TO F2 RUNNING IN ANGLE
- **JAB:** 9 PASSES TO F1 THE F1 PASSES TO F3 BEHIND F2, BUT THE KEY IS F2 STILL RUN HIS LINE TO DRAW DEFENDERS TOGETHER.
- **ESCAPE:** 9 PASSES TO F1 AND THEN BACK TO 9 WHO THEN PASSES TO 10 FOR OUTSIDE OPTIONS. Or F1 passes to 10 who is in the pocket behind setup. All forwards must still run there lines, for decoy.
- **RELOAD:** 9 passes to F1 and f2 runs his punch line. F1 passes to f4 and f4 has options. 1 hit the space or tip onto F3 to fix outside man.
- **10 CALL:** is a pass back inside F1. Only called if space opens up.

On our own attacking ball, we are using the ABCD rule in and around rucks.

- **A: AGGRESSOR**: Assist ball carrier with strong leg drive, clear the tackler back beyond the ball
- **B: BALL CARRIER:** Work hard to get to the ground and then present the ball cleanly
- **C: CLEAR OUT:** Assist 'Aggressor' by clearing defenders beyond the ball or become 'clearer passer'
- **D: DECISION:** Make the decision to clear out remaining defenders, protect the space or become 'clearer passer'

CHAOS (SLOW BALL)



- IF SLOW BALL, F1 AND F2 PICK AND GO.
- 9 BECOMES 'CLEARER PASSER' BUT BALL HAS TO BE QUICKLY PRESENTED
- 9 THEN PASSES ONTO F3 WITH F4. THEY HIT UP WIDER FROM RUCK 2, RUNNING HARD AND FAST AS IT IS DIFFICULT TO DEFEND.
- 9 THEN PASSES OUT TO 10, THIS WILL ALLOW QUICK BALL SO BACKS HAVE FAST BALL TO RUN ONTO.
- MINIMUM OF 2 HIT UPS, THEN BALL HAS TO GO OPEN OR BLIND.

Ronnie ball

When we are on the tryline, and picked and go a couple of times. We keep going the same way with the next two ready to hit up. But on the blind we have one player looking out of the play. 9 passes to first forward F1, but then passes to the blind forward F3, where he can slide over the line as player hips turned.

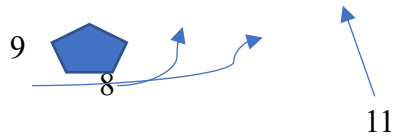
Ruck
9

F3 **F1**
F2

BACK ROW MOVES

YELLOW:

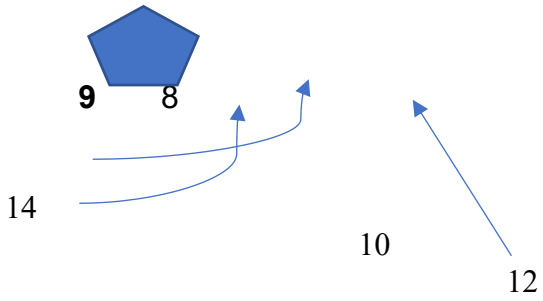
Scrum on right hand side of the pitch



8 pick up at the scrum and passes early to 9. 9 takes ball on and pulls in opposition to create a 2v1with our winger in support to take the pass. Looking for flanker and 8 for inside passes if required.

BLACK 1 or BLACK 2:

scrum on left of the pitch.



BLACK 1
8 pick and passes to 9. 9 drifts slightly away and passes to blind side winger behind 9. One winger will either keep ball alive or take contact beyond the gain line. If ruck is made, this will suck in key players to give us an outside edge for winger but ball must be played quickly.

BLACK 2
8 picks and passes to 9. 9 drifts slightly away from scrum and dummy passes to blind side winger. As above but passes to 12 who times their run on an inline. If ruck is made, we want to try and suck in key players, this will hopefully get us on the front foot forward.

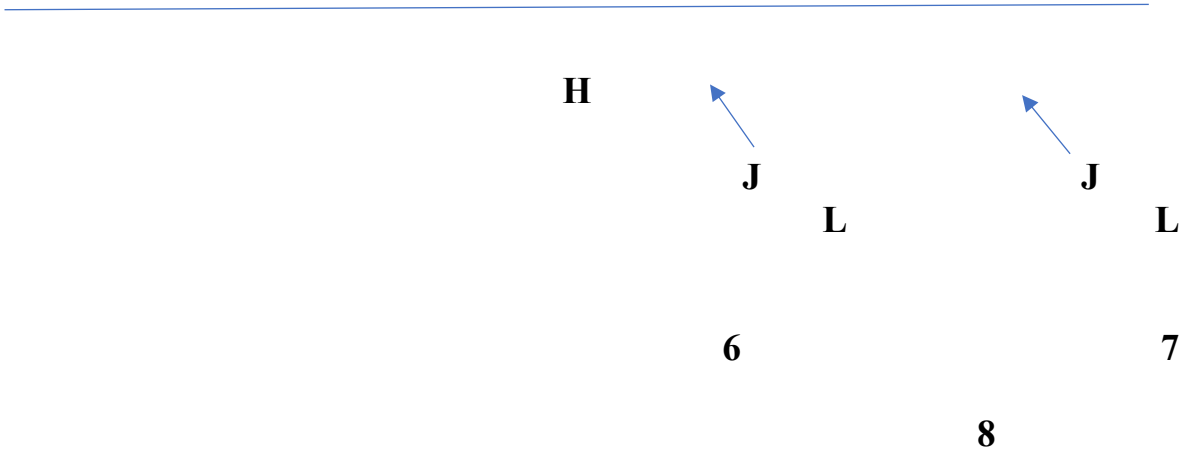
After black moves, the next phase will be for the first 4 fwds to play round the corner move off 9 (the play round the corner will mainly be a punch, if done quick enough).

KICK OFF

On our own kicks, we need to attack and target the ball in the air. We are looking for a fast fwd to target and jump for the ball in the air. Supporting fwds to form a diamond shape around him. If the ball is slapped backwards by both jumpers, we have supporting players in the area. (it's a 50/50 ball)

When receiving a kick want the jumper to attack the ball. Players work hard to get round catcher, then set up a maul or ruck. Once we have set up a maul or ruck, we want the ball in 9s hands quickly. Next phase will be a **LION** call on the openside or blindside, depending on where first ruck was formed (looking for 9 to make the call). If **ESCAPE** ball is called this gives 10 two options, kick to corners or keep ball alive in hands, this will create phases to get game plan started.

Receiving Kick setup



LINEOUTS

- All lineouts should be quick and dynamic.
- Nobody back pedals, always turn to run back to position and then lift.
- Beat the opposition by being first at the lineout
- If opposition not ready, get ball in.
- Keep the tempo of the game high.

LINEOUT CODES

- Four-digit number codes, middle two numbers indicating the number on jersey of the jumper and the space in the lineout where the ball goes (front =1, middle =2, back =3). E.g. a call for a front ball would be 7514 (jumper 5, space 1). Ball off the top straight to 9.
- A **COLOUR** means a **LOB BALL**, e.g. Red 7514, jumper takes 1 step forward then two steps back
- Anything starting with **S** is a switch ball
- Anything starting with **D** is a catch and drive.
- Anything starting with **P** is a pocket ball. Pocket means the Jumper returns to the ground and pops ball off to a runner or 9, e.g. POCKET 7514.
- All movement will be down the middle of the lineout. I.e. if middle jumper going to jump at front, he travels straight forward and others step out of space and fill in behind. The lifter behind the jumper also follows, keeping everything dynamic and quick.
- Hooker or thrower throws ball into lineout then jumper goes to meet the ball in the air, this stops the opposition getting up before us.
- 10 call: (called by the jumper) quick ball to 1 in lineout if the opposition is sleeping, this gives us a quick ball back into play.

LINEOUT SET UPS

FULL MAN LINEOUT

H/ / 1 4 3 5 6 7 8 /

SH

SIX MAN LINEOUT

H / / 1p 2j 3l 4l 5j 6p /

SH

FIVE MAN LINEOUT

H / /1p 2j 3j 4j 5p /

SH

THREE MAN LINEOUT

H/ /1p 4j 5j /

SH

FOUR MAN LINEOUT

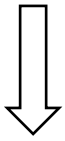
H / / 9 1p 5j 6j /

4J

ATTACKING LINEOUTS ON OPPOSITION TRYLINE

SOUTH AFRICA:

H: 1435678: **1 DUMMY lifts 4 at the front, ball thrown to 5 in the middle, 3 & 6 lifts and binds (to sell the drive) onto 5 who comes back to ground. 5 then passes the ball to number 4 who sprints between 7 & 8. 7 & 8 then support 4 over the line**



H: 1 356 748:

SWEENIE BALL:

Ball is a lob ball to 4. Ball off the top to hooker who is running into pitch, 5 runs towards the side line receives a pop pass from the hooker and targets the blind side channel (this move is only done 5 meters from opposition's try line).

DRIVE BALL:

Jumper will come down to the ground and the two lifters turn and face forward in the direction of the drive. First person in will take the ball. The player has to stay attached to the jumper at all times. The ball is transferred by hand rather than the player sliding backwards. The ball must travel down the middle of the maul, this gives us a narrow and tight maul by using short steps to move it forward. The maul should be driven slightly inwards and then straightened.

SWITCH BALL: full man lineout

Normal call for lineout, for where ball is going to be thrown. Once caught at highest point, (e.g. if ball thrown to back) front of lineout step back off line.Then the ball is passed down to front jumper. Then a maul can be setup once opposition had made contact to the maul. Same if ball goes to front lifter, then the back lifter steps out to take the pass off the top.

DEFENSIVE LINEOUTS

ON A FULL LINEOUT

- Lineout organised into two pods, each pod two lifters and a jumper.
- The 1st Pod will be called A and will consist of 2, 4 and 1.
- The 2nd Pod will be called B and will consist of 3, 5 and 6.

If opposition calls a shortened lineout, 9 should stand at front of lineout. Our jumper stands at 9 position in lineout. When opposition throws the ball, jumper steps into the space where the ball is thrown to and competes against their jumper. 9 sweeps round.

If **BLITZ** is called, we will not compete against throw and sack their catcher as soon as he touches the deck. The two players either side of the sacker look to drive through between their lifters and catcher as soon as they hit deck, this stops the opposition from setting up drives or plays and slows them down.

Backs Moves

Start Positions

10

11 12 13

15

14

POLO: straight hands

MUNSTER: 10 cuts with 12, 10 then hits 12 or 13 on the angle

SPENCER: 10 pops to 12, 10 loops 12, 13 fake crashes outside 12, 12 pops to 10 as 13 arrives, 10 hits 15 running a wide hard line, then we keep ball alive down channel, 10 supports.

STRIKE: 10 dummys with 12, 10 passes to 11 behind 12.

EXETER: 9 passes to 10. 10 & 12 drift wide together, 13 comes round the back and does a cut with 10, 11 in support. 10 and 12 needs to drift early to make defence drift also. Once in space keep ball alive.

MUNSTER WEDGE: 10 dummy cuts with 12, 13 runs a block line, 10 gives to 15 close

WIPER: (options kick or run)10 misses 12 and passes to 13, 13 kicks to corners. 0r 13 run if defender winger sitting in the pocket.

WEDGE: if there is a blitz defence, 9 to 11 behind 10 and then 11 to 15 down opposite channel. Keep ball alive and flood channel with all Backs in support.

FRANK: 10 misses 12 to 13. 13 is coming back into pass, does a bad loop with 12. 12 releases any of the back 3 or goes himself.

CARTER: 10 passes to 13 as 12 run a block, 13 passes to 15 as 14 runs a block

STEVIE: 9 to 10 cuts with 12 and give pass. Then 12 to 11 on either inside or outside

ACCIES: 9 to 11, 12 running inline with pass to 10 in behind 12.

WASPS: 8 pick up from scrum attacks 12 inside shoulder. 12 on inline run to oppo 10. 11 runs to oppo 10 12 channel. 9 runs to oppo 12 13 channel, 10 runs to oppo 13 inside shoulder. 13 runs outside 13 oppo. 8 can pass 9,11 or 12.

Bath: 9 to 12, 13 running in line 10 loops 12. 12 passes to 10 or 13. 10 release back three on outside edge.

Back door: basic move all players should be able to execute, e.g. 12 passing to 15 with 13 running block line

10: This is called by a player who has a gap or space in front of him, we try and get the ball in to their hands as quickly as possible.

All plays must be played on the gain line to ask questions of the defence.

Backs kick calls

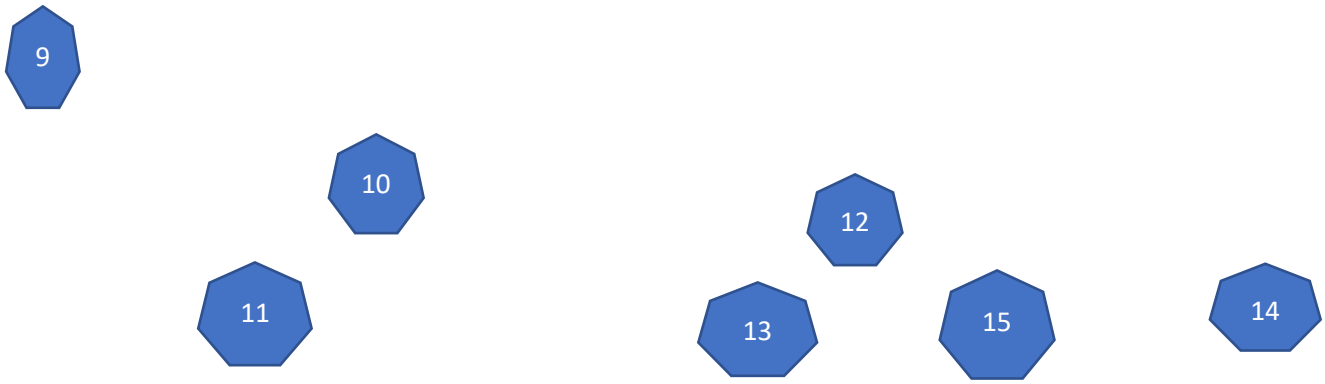
APPLE: Box kick
PEAR: Grubber kick
ORANGE: kick to corner

Communication between Backs and Forwards. Telling Fwds where the back strike move will be on the next phase.

C: Close
M: Middle
S: Spread

BACKS STRIKE MOVE IN OPPOSITION 22

TARANAKI BALL



Looking to set across the pitch, with 12 setting up across from opposition 13. The basis of this is to create 2v1 depending on the opposition defence setup initially. Backs always ready to receive a pass at any moment. Called made early depending on defence setup.

Options for 10, call A:

A1: 10 runs an out-angle with 11 on the inside.
A2: 10 runs an in-angle and 11 on the outside of 10
A3: 10 runs straight to fix defender and 13 gets ball outside
A4: 10 fixes defender, 13 takes dummy crash ball and ball passed behind 13 to 11.

Options for 12, call B: (ball passed quickly to 12 from 10)

B1: 12 fixes oppo 13, 13 runs on the inside 12 to hold opposition 12. Pass is given to 15 on the outside to create 2v1 with winger, this depends on where 15 sets up behind the defence line.
B2: 12 passed to 13 on inside, if there is a gap on the inside of the defence. Looking for 10 and 11 support.
B3: 12 passes to 11 on the inside, with 13 support hopefully holding defender and 13 going through the gap.
B4: 12 passes to 13 on the inside, with 11 and 15 giving 13 options on both sides of attack.
B5: instead of 10 passing to 12, 9 loops 10 with 9 getting pass. 9 onto 15, with 12 running in-angle to fix defenders inside. 15 with 13 and 14 support attack outside channel. Good option if we have an outside edge.

Attacking Defence

Our mindset in defence is to **regain possession** of the ball.

Dynamic defensive line speed for the **first three steps (zoom, paddle, zoom)** is essential to close the space quickly and put opposition under pressure with ball in hand (limit the options for the ball carrier), this also stops attacking player getting up to speed and make them easier to tackle.

We are looking for a **double tackle** most of the time to try and stop offloads.

In defence we should aim to **"chop, lock and block"** – first player should always chop the legs, second player should lock up the ball (watching height) and third player can block the offload or ruck beyond the ball. Even if we don't win the ball at the ruck it will slow down opposition ball and help our defence to set up for next phase.

Force the attacking team to run around us: close the space and only drift when the player outside your defending player passes the ball, stop the pass-back option into your channel.

We will defend against kicks and wide attacks using a **pendulum defence**: wingers and fullbacks work together to provide defensive width and depth.

FORWARDS DO NOT "HONEY POT": Work hard to get into the defensive line. There should never be more than three defenders in a tackle situation, we want more players on their feet than opposition.

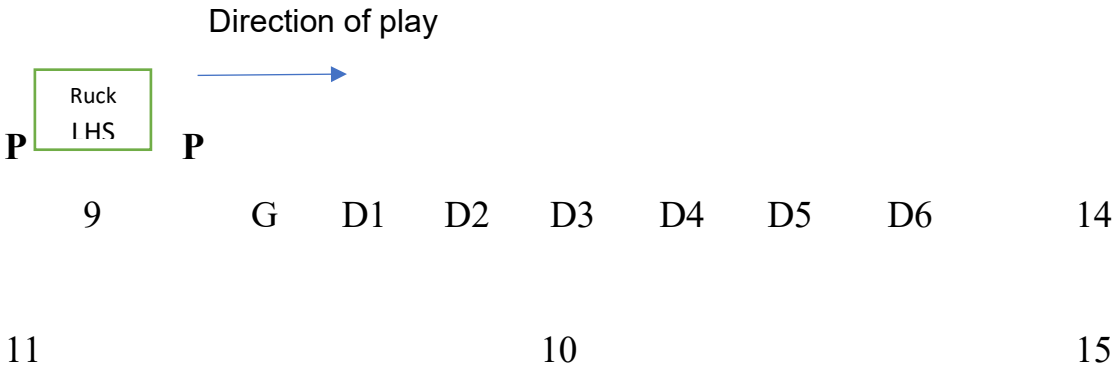
DO NOT SELL OUT YOUR TEAMMATES by taking a 'breather' and asking them to cover your spaces, this will give the opposition an overlap somewhere.

If scrum half calls **LOST,** leave the ball alone and get into a defensive line across the pitch.

If you hear **RESET** called, repeat the call and take a step backward to ensure we bring the defensive line onside. **Cheap penalties are not acceptable**.

DEFENCE SET UP

P: PILAR
LHS: LEFTHAND SIDE
G: GUARD



It's the same if we are on the right hand side, where 11 will be in line and 14 drops back. Always wanting three at the back to cover the area. If the ball is kicked to the side lines and caught, we want the ball to be passed to middle of the pitch as fast as we can. The ball carrier can scan the pitch to see what options we have: e.g. kick back into space, run into space or run back in to where our forwards are and restart our game plan.

Counter Attack

Tackle turnover
Ball to 10 ASAP – ball played into space (heads up rugby)

Opposition Kick
If opposition turnover our ball and kick it down the park then we need any 3 players to drop back, retrieve the ball and create a 3 man spread counter attack.
Rest of the players form a defensive line to create counter attack doors.
9 follows the ball, to direct the attack after the first tackle.

PAISLEY Kick
Three players drop back to create 3 man spread, in case of potential return kick.
Nearest to kicker chases the ball, with another 2 players, putting pressure on the kick receiver, this will limit his options (e.g. make tackle or force a kick).
Rest of players form defensive line to cover opposition counter attack.
9 sweeps behind defensive line to cover/organise line.